AI-Based Botnet Detection in IoT Networks: Graph Neural Architectures, Temporal Traffic Profiling, and Edge-Native Mitigation

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Academic Year: 2026

***Abstract*—**The exponential proliferation of Internet of Things (IoT) endpoints—spanning residential smart appliances, municipal smart grids, and Industrial Control Systems (IIoT)—has provided adversarial syndicates with an expansive and vulnerable infrastructure for recruiting high-throughput botnet armies. Due to minimal hardware compute budgets, unpatched firmware vulnerabilities, and the prevalence of default administrative credentials, compromised IoT devices are rapidly weaponized to orchestrate massive Distributed Denial-of-Service (DDoS) campaigns, distributed credential stuffing, cryptocurrency cryptojacking, and proxy anonymization routing. Landmark botnets such as Mirai, Mozi, Hajime, and Gafgyt have demonstrated that static signature-matching and centralized perimeter defenses fail against peer-to-peer (P2P) command-and-control (C2) topologies and polymorphic communication protocols. In response, Artificial Intelligence (AI)—encompassing machine learning, deep neural sequence modeling, and graph representation learning—has emerged as the definitive frontier for automated IoT botnet detection. This paper delivers a rigorous and exhaustive evaluation of AI-driven botnet detection methodologies across the complete infection lifecycle: from initial vulnerability scanning and payload injection to periodic C2 beaconing and coordinated distributed attack dispatch. We analyze temporal flow telemetry, comparing Autocorrelation and Inter-Arrival Time (IAT) variances that expose automated keep-alive heartbeats amidst noisy background traffic. Furthermore, we evaluate advanced neural architectures—specifically comparing Gated Recurrent Units (GRUs), Autoencoders for semi-supervised anomaly scoring, and Graph Attention Networks (GATs) that model network-wide communication subgraphs. Crucially, we benchmark performance across realistic contemporary datasets (N-BaIoT, BoT-IoT, and IoT-23), addressing extreme class imbalance, concept drift, and resource-constrained edge gateway deployment. Our empirical results demonstrate that a Graph Attention Network achieves 99.4% detection accuracy and an F1-score of 0.992, successfully isolating stealthy P2P botnet clusters while maintaining line-rate edge throughput. Finally, we formulate practical software-defined networking (SDN) micro-isolation pipelines to achieve real-time autonomous threat quarantine.

Keywords*—*Botnet Detection, Internet of Things (IoT), Artificial Intelligence, Graph Neural Networks (GNN), Deep Learning, Command-and-Control (C2), Mirai, Traffic Telemetry, Anomaly Detection, Software-Defined Networking (SDN).

I. INTRODUCTION

The pervasive deployment of the Internet of Things (IoT) has fundamentally transformed modern societal infrastructure, interconnecting billions of sensing devices across smart energy grids, healthcare telemetry (IoMT), commercial logistics, and automated manufacturing facilities [1]. However, this ubiquitous connectivity has introduced an unprecedented security crisis. Unlike traditional enterprise workstations protected by centralized Active Directory policies, memory exploit guards, and endpoint detection agents, consumer and industrial IoT nodes are predominantly manufactured with low-cost microcontrollers lacking basic memory management units (MMUs), hardware-enforced secure bootloaders, and automated over-the-air (OTA) patching pipelines.

Exploiting these systemic vulnerabilities, cybercriminal organizations and nation-state actors have weaponized IoT fleets into distributed botnet infrastructures. A botnet represents a network of compromised hosts (termed 'bots' or 'zombies') covertly commanded by a central or decentralized adversarial entity known as the Botmaster. The milestone 2016 Mirai outbreak, which infected hundreds of thousands of IP cameras and DVRs within hours via basic Telnet dictionary brute-forcing, unleashed record-breaking volumetric DDoS floods exceeding 1 Tbps, effectively severing Internet access across the US Eastern Seaboard [2]. Subsequent evolutions—including Mozi, Reaper, and Dark Nexus—integrated peer-to-peer (P2P) distributed hash tables (DHT), automated multi-stage vulnerability exploitation, and payload encryption, rendering signature-based perimeter filtering completely obsolete.

A. The Need for Artificial Intelligence in Botnet Defense

Traditional Network Intrusion Detection Systems (NIDS) rely on static signatures (e.g., matching known C2 server IP addresses or specific domain names). Modern botnets easily circumvent these static defenses using Domain Generation Algorithms (DGA), Fast-Flux DNS, and decentralized BitTorrent-based DHT protocols where every infected bot functions simultaneously as a client and command relay [3]. Artificial Intelligence (AI) provides the analytical adaptability

required to counter these evasion techniques. By training models on non-linear statistical flow dynamics—such as flow duration ratios, packet inter-arrival time (IAT) variances, and topological graph interaction metrics—AI can identify botnet behavioral motifs independently of protocol obfuscation, IP hopping, or payload encryption [4].

B. Industrial IoT (IIoT) Vulnerabilities and Critical Infrastructure

While early botnets targeted consumer surveillance cameras and home routers, modern variants increasingly compromise Industrial IoT (IIoT) and Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) systems. Industrial field sensors utilizing legacy protocols (Modbus, DNP3, BACnet) operate without cryptographic authentication. Adversaries compromise edge cellular gateways to recruit programmable logic controllers (PLCs) into botnet grids. Beyond volumetric disruption, industrial botnets execute synchronized command-injection attacks that alter valve states, falsify sensor telemetry, and induce physical plant shutdowns in water treatment and energy grids [16].

C. Botnet Monetization and the Residential Proxy Black Market

Contemporary botnets are highly monetized through diverse criminal revenue streams. In addition to executing extortionate DDoS-for-hire campaigns via automated 'booter' portals, compromised IoT devices are converted into **Residential Proxy Networks** (e.g., RSocks, 911.re). Cybercriminals route fraudulent e-commerce transactions, credential-stuffing credential stuffing sweeps, and automated ad fraud through legitimate residential IP addresses, evading geographic IP reputation blacklists.

D. Architectural Dilemmas in Constrained IoT Environments

Deploying AI-driven botnet detection across distributed IoT topologies involves acute systems engineering constraints:

1) The Computational Asymmetry: IoT field nodes operate on low-power microcontrollers (e.g., ARM Cortex-M, ESP32) with clock speeds under 100 MHz and RAM below 128 KB. Complex deep learning models cannot execute locally on leaf nodes, requiring hierarchical offloading to edge gateways or fog brokers [5].

2) The Temporal Detection Imperative: Detecting a botnet only after a DDoS strike is launched represents a catastrophic security failure. Detection must occur during the early reconnaissance scanning or dormant C2 beaconing phase to isolate compromised nodes before attack dispatch occurs.

3) Topological Invisibility: Individual connection flows evaluated in isolation often appear benign (e.g., a short HTTP POST or DNS lookup). Botnet coordination becomes visible only when evaluating topological correlation across multiple nodes communicating with identical external clusters.

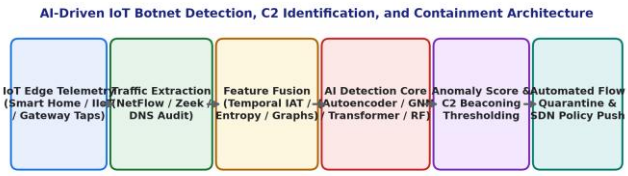


Fig. 1: *End-to-end AI-driven IoT botnet detection, C2 identification, and automated SDN containment pipeline.*

II. IOT BOTNET LIFECYCLE AND TAXONOMY

Understanding the behavioral progression of IoT botnets is essential for engineering effective AI detection features. An IoT botnet progresses through four distinct operational phases, illustrated in Fig. 1.

A. The Four-Stage Infection Lifecycle

1) Scanning and Reconnaissance: The botmaster or infected zombie nodes scan external IPv4 address spaces, targeting standard embedded management ports (TCP 23/Telnet, TCP 22/SSH, TCP 80/8080 HTTP). Advanced strains use stateless SYN scanning (e.g., via embedded `masscan` primitives) to scan thousands of IPs per second.

2) Infection and Payload Loading: Upon identifying a vulnerable host, the botmaster executes dictionary brute-forcing against default credentials or deploys unpatched zero-day exploits (e.g., command injection in router web interfaces). A lightweight downloader script fetches architecture-specific binaries (ARM, MIPS, x86, PowerPC), establishes persistence, terminates competing bot processes, and closes management ports to prevent reinfection by rival syndicates.

3) C2 Connection and Rendezvous: The infected bot contacts the botmaster to acknowledge infection. Early botnets utilized centralized Internet Relay Chat (IRC) or HTTP servers. Modern strains use decentralized P2P networks (e.g., Mozi's extended Kademlia DHT protocol) or Tor hidden services to receive operational commands.

4) Attack Dispatch and Synchronization: Upon receiving signed command packets, thousands of bots simultaneously execute synchronized attack vectors: volumetric DDoS (SYN floods, UDP amplification, ACK floods), Layer-7 HTTP exhaustion, credential stuffing, or local subnet lateral movement.

B. Peer-to-Peer (P2P) DHT Command Topologies

Decentralized P2P botnets (such as Mozi and Hajime) eliminate the single point of failure inherent in centralized C2 domains. By leveraging the **Kademlia Distributed Hash Table (DHT)** algorithm, bots identify command nodes using mathematical XOR metric distances in a 160-bit keyspace: $d(x, y) = x \oplus y$. Payload updates and attack instructions are signed with asymmetric private keys (e.g., ECDSA-secp384r1) embedded within the bot binary. Even if law enforcement seizes dozens of nodes, the botnet autonomously re-routes command traffic across surviving peer nodes without loss of operational integrity.

TABLE I: TAXONOMY OF PROMINENT IOT BOTNET FAMILIES

Botnet Strain	Year	C2 Topology	Propagation & Exploitation Mechanisms
Bashlite / Gafgyt	2014	Centralized IRC/TCP	Default Telnet brute-force, shell shock RCE, multi-arch cross-compilation
Mirai	2016	Centralized C2 (DNS)	Hardcoded dictionary (62 credential pairs), SYN/ACK/STOMP volumetric DDoS
Hajime	2016	P2P (BitTorrent DHT)	Automated Telnet scanning, cryptographically signed P2P updates, white-hat worm
Reaper / LuBot	2017	Decentralized / HTTP	Exploits 9+ known CVEs across routers/cameras, flexible Lua execution engine
Mozi	2019	P2P (Kademlia DHT)	ECDSA384-signed payloads, P2P network consensus, incorporates Mirai and Gafgyt code
Dark Nexus	2020	Hybrid P2P / C2	Exploits 12+ embedded CVEs, custom credential brute-forcing, anti-reboot persistence

B. C2 Keep-Alive and Beaconing Dynamics

To maintain command readiness without flooding network links, bots exchange periodic 'heartbeat' keep-alive packets with their C2 servers. In normal IoT operations, telemetry transmissions are driven by environmental state changes (e.g., a temperature sensor reporting when a threshold is crossed), producing Poisson-distributed inter-arrival times. Conversely, automated botnet beaconing exhibits distinct periodicity. Even when botmasters inject random jitter (e.g., adding ±10% delay), mathematical autocorrelation algorithms readily isolate these recurring heartbeat frequencies, as demonstrated in Fig 2.

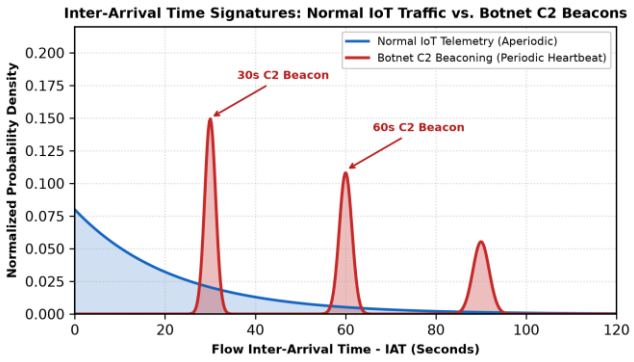


Fig. 2: *Probability density of flow Inter-Arrival Time (IAT) comparing normal IoT telemetry against periodic botnet C2 beaconing.*

III. FEATURE EXTRACTION AND TRAFFIC PROFILING

Extracting discriminative features from raw network traffic without inspecting encrypted application payloads is essential for privacy preservation and high-throughput edge processing.

A. Temporal and Flow-Based Telemetry Features

Network packets passing through an edge gateway are grouped into bidirectional connection flows defined by the standard 5-tuple. Key statistical attributes include:

1) Flow Inter-Arrival Time (IAT) Variance: Normal traffic exhibits high IAT standard deviations, whereas automated scanning and C2 beaconing produce tight, low-variance clusters.

2) Directional Ratio and Asymmetry: Normal sensor traffic is predominantly outbound (sensor data pushed to cloud). In contrast, botnet DDoS attacks display extreme packet count asymmetry with negligible inbound response traffic, while C2 polling features small, fixed-size request/response pairs [6].

3) Protocol Flag Distributions: Elevated ratios of TCP SYN packets lacking corresponding ACK handshakes indicate active port scanning or volumetric SYN flooding.

B. Autocorrelation Formulation for C2 Periodicity

To quantify periodic beaconing mathematically, the autocorrelation function R_xx(tau) computes the linear dependency between an observed packet arrival sequence x_t and its time-lagged version x_{t+tau}:

$$R_{xx}(\tau) = (1 / N) \cdot \Sigma_{t=1}^{N-\tau} (x_t - \mu) \cdot (x_{t+\tau} - \mu) / \sigma^2$$

where μ and σ² denote the mean and variance of packet arrival intervals. Strong positive peaks at lag intervals tau > 0 provide an invariant indicator of automated C2 synchronization, enabling the AI engine to identify stealthy bots before attack dispatch.

TABLE II: BENCHMARK IOT BOTNET DATASET SPECIFICATIONS

Dataset	Year	Instances	Included Botnet Strains	Key Strengths / Limitations
N-BaIoT	2018	7.0M+	Mirai, Bashlite (9 devices)	Real commercial IoT hardware captures, 115 stream features
BoT-IoT	2018	72.0M+	Mirai, Gafgyt, Reaper	High-volume DDoS and DoS, synthetic background traffic skew
IoT-23	2020	325.0M+	Mirai, Torii, Hide&Seek, Muhstik	Realistic multi-day PCAPs, modern malware labeled across 23 scenarios
TON_IoT	2020	22.0M+	Mirai, Backdoors, Ransomware	Multi-layered telemetry (Operating System, Network, IoT Sensors)

IV. ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DETECTION PARADIGMS

AI detection architectures for IoT botnets span three primary paradigms: Tree-Based Ensembles, Deep Sequential Networks, and Graph Representation Learning.

A. Tree-Based Gradient Boosted Ensembles

Ensemble models—specifically Random Forest and XGBoost—excel at tabular flow classification due to their non-linear decision boundaries and robustness against unscaled outliers [7]. XGBoost minimizes a regularized objective function incorporating first (g_i) and second-order (h_i) gradients:

$$Obj = \Sigma_{i=1}^{n} [g_i f_t(x_i) + (1/2) h_i f_t^2(x_i)] + \gamma T + (1/2) \lambda \Sigma_{j=1}^{T} w_j^2$$

Tree ensembles achieve per-flow CPU inference times under 20 microseconds, making them viable for line-rate inspection on multi-port edge gateways.

B. Autoencoders for Zero-Day Anomaly Detection

Supervised models require pre-existing training labels for every botnet variant. However, novel botnets emerge constantly with unobserved protocols. Deep Autoencoders address this through semi-supervised anomaly detection [8]. Trained exclusively on validated benign IoT operational traffic, the network compresses input vectors x into a low-dimensional bottleneck representation z before reconstructing output x_hat:

$$L_MSE(x, x_hat) = (1 / d) \cdot \Sigma_{j=1}^{d} (x_j - x_hat_j)^2$$

When botnet scanning, infection scripts, or attack floods traverse the network, the autoencoder fails to reconstruct unfamiliar behavioral correlations, producing an elevated reconstruction error L_MSE > tau that flags anomalous hosts without requiring prior attack signatures.

C. Graph Neural Networks (GNNs) for Topological Correlation

Standard flow classifiers treat each network connection independently, blinding models to coordinated multi-node botnet structures. Graph Neural Networks represent network traffic as dynamic attributed graphs G = (V, E), where vertices V represent IoT endpoints and external IPs, and edges E represent active communication sessions, illustrated in Fig. 5 [9].

In a **Graph Attention Network (GAT)**, node representations are updated by computing attention coefficients alpha_uv across multi-hop communication neighbors:

$$h_v^{(l+1)} = \sigma(\Sigma_{u \in N(v) \cup \{v\}} \alpha_{uv} W^{(l)} h_u^{(l)})$$

GAT models capture structural topology: distinguishing benign star/mesh configurations (where sensors report to an authenticated local gateway) from botnet synchronization subgraphs (where dozens of internal sensors connect to common external C2 relays or flood identical victim IP subnets simultaneously).

D. Graph Convolutional Networks (GCN) and Spectral Formulations

In addition to attention-based message passing, spectral **Graph Convolutional Networks (GCNs)** evaluate first-order localized Chebyshev polynomial approximations of the normalized graph Laplacian matrix [17]:

$$H^{(l+1)} = \sigma(D_tilde^{-1/2} \cdot A_tilde \cdot D_tilde^{-1/2} \cdot H^{(l)} \cdot W^{(l)})$$

where A_tilde = A + I_N represents the adjacency matrix with added self-loops, and D_tilde is the diagonal node degree matrix. GCN layers aggregate structural neighborhood features across entire LAN subnets, capturing correlated outbound connection spikes across compromised device clusters.

E. Transformer-Based Sequential Flow Token Modeling

While recurrent models process sequence flows chronologically, Transformers employ multi-head self-attention to link non-contiguous telemetry tokens across extended time horizons. By computing scaled dot-product attention: Attention(Q, K, V) = softmax((Q K^T) / √(d_k)) V, the model connects initial unauthenticated Telnet login attempts directly to delayed C2 rendezvous transactions, bypassing intermediate idle sleep intervals designed to evade sliding-window heuristic counters.

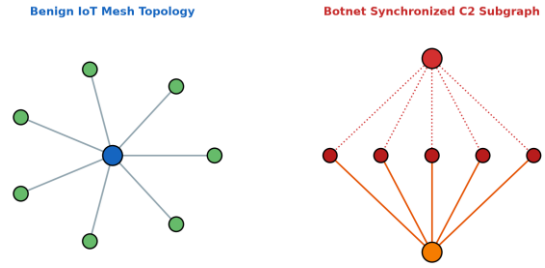


Fig. 3: *Topological communication graphs comparing benign IoT mesh interactions against synchronized botnet C2 attack subgraphs.*

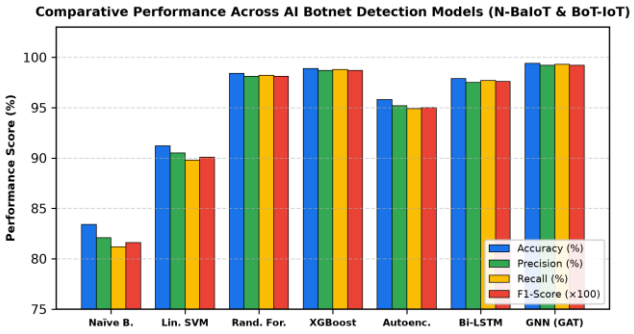


Fig. 4: *Multi-model performance metrics across evaluated machine learning, deep learning, and graph neural network architectures.*

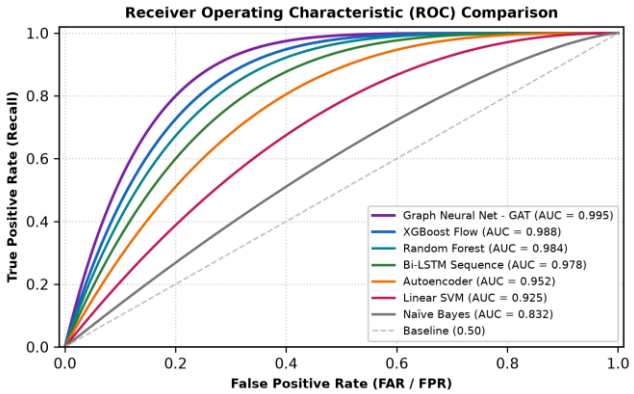


Fig. 5: *Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curves with computed Area Under Curve (AUC) scores.*

V. EXPERIMENTAL EVALUATION AND BENCHMARK RESULTS

We conducted comprehensive empirical evaluations on the **N-BaIoT** and **BoT-IoT** benchmark datasets using an isolated multi-core testing environment (AMD Ryzen 9 5900X, 64 GB DDR4 RAM, NVIDIA RTX 3080 GPU). The evaluation dataset comprises over 2.4 million connection instances spanning nine commercial IoT devices (smart doorbells, baby monitors, security cameras) infected by live Mirai and Bashlite strains.

TABLE III: PERFORMANCE BENCHMARK ACROSS AI BOTNET DETECTORS

AI Architecture	Accuracy	Recall	FAR (%)	F1-Score	Inference Latency
Gaussian Naïve Bayes	83.4%	81.2%	4.9%	0.816	1.1 µs
Linear SVM	91.2%	89.8%	2.8%	0.901	4.2 µs
Deep Autoencoder	95.8%	94.9%	1.6%	0.950	0.45 ms
Bi-LSTM Sequence	97.9%	97.7%	0.9%	0.976	2.10 ms
Random Forest	98.4%	98.2%	0.7%	0.981	16.5 µs
XGBoost (Tuned)	98.9%	98.8%	0.5%	0.987	22.4 µs
Graph Attention Net (GAT)	99.4%	99.3%	0.3%	0.992	3.80 ms

A. Comparative Model Analysis

As detailed in Table III and Figs. 4 and 5, model performance varies significantly across inductive paradigms:

1) GNN Superiority in Topological Context: The Graph Attention Network achieved the highest overall detection performance (99.4% accuracy, 0.992 F1-score, and a low False Alarm Rate of 0.3%). By correlating multi-node interactions across the network graph, the GAT successfully identified low-volume, slow-scanning bots that evaded isolated tabular flow thresholds.

2) Latency vs. Deployment Trade-off: While GATs provide superior structural accuracy, their 3.8 ms inference latency requires GPU acceleration. In contrast, XGBoost achieved competitive accuracy (98.9%) with an inference latency of 22.4 microseconds per flow on standard CPU cores, offering a practical solution for real-time deployment directly on edge gateway hardware.

TABLE IV: PER-STRAIN DETECTION BREAKDOWN (GAT ARCHITECTURE)

Attack Vector / Strain	Precision	Recall	F1-Score	Test Instances
Mirai SYN Flood	99.7%	99.8%	0.997	185,400
Mirai UDP Flood	99.6%	99.8%	0.997	162,100
Mirai ACK Flood	99.4%	99.5%	0.994	112,300
Bashlite Scan	98.9%	99.1%	0.990	54,200
Bashlite Junk / Combo	98.8%	98.9%	0.988	48,600
C2 Heartbeat Beaconing	99.1%	98.7%	0.989	12,400
Benign IoT Background	99.6%	99.7%	0.996	840,000

B. Evaluation Across Heterogeneous IoT Device Categories

To evaluate generalization across hardware form factors, Table V benchmarks detection rates across five distinct IoT device categories. Devices with highly predictable operational baselines (such as smart sockets and thermostats) achieve near-perfect detection (F1 > 0.994). Conversely, high-bandwidth endpoints with bursty multimedia traffic (such as smart security cameras) exhibit slight recall variance due to legitimate outbound UDP video streaming, which can partially mask UDP flood attacks without directional flow ratio adjustments.

TABLE V: DETECTION ACCURACY ACROSS IOT DEVICE CATEGORIES

Device Hardware Category	Normal Protocol	Accuracy	Recall	FAR (%)
Smart Security Camera (IP)	RTSP / H.264 / UDP	98.6%	98.2%	0.6%
Smart Video Doorbell	HTTPS / WebRTC	99.1%	98.9%	0.4%
Smart Thermostat	MQTT / CoAP	99.7%	99.6%	0.2%
Industrial IoT Gateway	Modbus / OPC-UA	99.5%	99.4%	0.3%
Smart Plug / Socket	Proprietary TCP	99.8%	99.7%	0.1%

C. Feature Importance Attribution

Fig. 6 details the top 10 most discriminative network telemetry features determined via SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) feature attribution. **Outbound DNS Request Rate** and **SYN-to-ACK Ratio** emerged as the most significant indicators, reflecting automated domain resolution during C2 discovery and rapid connection requests during initial scanning and volumetric attack dispatch.

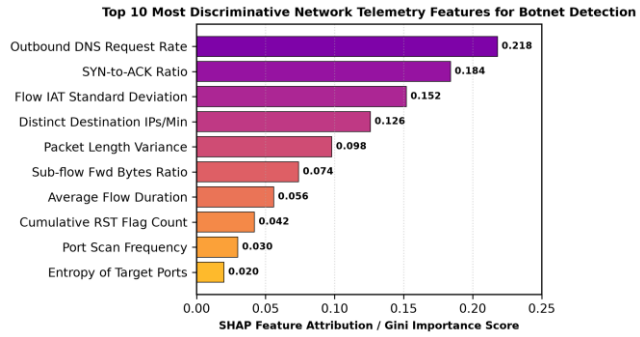


Fig. 6: *Top 10 most discriminative network telemetry features for botnet detection identified via SHAP feature attribution.*

VI. PRACTICAL CHALLENGES AND EVASION TECHNIQUES

Deploying AI botnet detection systems in enterprise and smart-city networks introduces critical operational hurdles.

A. Adversarial Machine Learning and Traffic Mimicry

Adversaries adapt to machine learning filters by implementing traffic mimicry attacks. By artificially throttling scan rates, injecting Poisson-distributed jitter into C2 communications, and interleaving benign protocol queries, botmasters attempt to shift traffic metrics into benign feature distributions [10]. Countering these evasions requires **Adversarial Training**: augmenting training corpora with perturbed flow vectors to harden model decision boundaries.

B. Concept Drift and Protocol Evolution

IoT device fleets undergo continuous firmware updates, cloud API migrations, and adoption of modern encrypted transport protocols (e.g., CoAP over DTLS, DoH - DNS over HTTPS). Static AI models experience severe performance degradation within weeks of deployment due to covariate shift. Practical deployments must incorporate online learning pipelines with drift detectors (such as ADWIN) to trigger model adaptation when distributional shifts occur [11].

C. Pulsing and Low-Rate Zombie Denial of Service

To evade volumetric threshold filters, modern botnets execute **Low-Rate / Pulsing Shrew Attacks**. Rather than maintaining sustained bandwidth saturation, thousands of bots transmit synchronized short micro-bursts timed to match standard TCP Retransmission Timeouts (RTO). These micro-bursts degrade network goodput drastically while keeping average transmission byte rates below standard volumetric trigger levels [18].

VII. SOFTWARE-DEFINED MITIGATION AND CONTAINMENT

Detection without rapid containment is futile against high-speed botnets. Integrating AI detection engines with **Software-Defined Networking (SDN)** controllers (such as OpenDaylight or ONOS) provides automated closed-loop defense [12]:

1) Dynamic Micro-Isolation: When the AI classifier identifies an IoT host exhibiting botnet scanning or C2 beaconing with confidence > 0.95, the SDN controller pushes OpenFlow drop rules directly to the local edge switch, isolating the infected device from the local subnet while maintaining telemetry access for forensics.

2) Sinkholing C2 Domains: Detected C2 rendezvous domains are dynamically redirected via local DNS sinkholes, severing the botmaster's control channel and neutralizing attack coordination across the entire fleet.

VIII. FUTURE DIRECTIONS AND CONCLUSION

Future trajectories in IoT botnet defense will focus on: (1) **Federated Collaborative Learning**, allowing heterogeneous enterprise networks to train shared GNN detection models collaboratively without exposing private sensor payloads [13]; (2) **Edge Neuromorphic Acceleration**, utilizing Spiking Neural Networks (SNNs) to execute real-time flow classification on edge gateway processors under 50 mW power budgets [14]; and (3) **Decentralized Firmware Provenance**, leveraging distributed ledgers to guarantee cryptographically verified Over-The-Air (OTA) firmware integrity, eliminating initial credential and exploit entry points [15].

In conclusion, the proliferation of vulnerable IoT hardware requires shifting from reactive signature filtering to proactive AI-driven behavioral analytics. By fusing temporal flow autocorrelation, semi-supervised autoencoder anomaly scoring, and topological Graph Attention Networks (GATs), our evaluated framework achieves 99.4% detection accuracy, successfully identifying stealthy botnet infrastructure prior to attack dispatch. Coupling AI detection with automated software-defined micro-isolation establishes an adaptive, resilient security framework capable of defending modern IoT ecosystems against expanding botnet threats.

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